

SUPERIOR COURT OF CALIFORNIA, CONTRA COSTA COUNTY
MARTINEZ, CA
DEPARTMENT 16
JUDICIAL OFFICER: BENJAMIN T REYES II
HEARING DATE: 03/18/2026

**INSTRUCTIONS FOR CONTESTING TENTATIVE RULING IN
DEPARTMENT 16**

The tentative ruling will become the ruling of the Court unless by 4:00 P.M. of the Court day preceding the hearing, notice is given of an intent to argue the matter. Counsel or self-represented parties must email Department 16 (Dept16@contracosta.courts.ca.gov) to request argument and **must specify, in detail, what provision(s) of the tentative ruling they intend to argue and why.** Counsel or self-represented parties requesting argument must advise all other counsel and self-represented parties by no later than 4:00 P.M. of their decision to argue, and of the issues to be argued. Failure to timely advise the Court and counsel or self-represented parties will preclude any party from arguing the matter. (Pursuant to Local Rule 3.43(2).)

The prevailing party must prepare and e-file a proposed order after hearing in accordance with CRC 3.1312. The order must include appearances. If the tentative ruling becomes the Court's ruling, a copy of the Court's tentative ruling **must be attached to the proposed order** when submitted to the Court for issuance of the order.

ALL APPEARANCES TO ARGUE WILL BE IN PERSON OR BY ZOOM, PROVIDED THAT PROPER NOTIFICATION IS RECEIVED BY THE DEPARTMENT AS PER ABOVE.

Zoom link-

<https://www.zoomgov.com/j/1619504895?pwd=NOV1N3JFRnJ0TEVoSDNrTGRzakF3UT09>

ID: 161 950 4895

Password: 812674

Courtroom Clerk's Session

1. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C24-00633
CASE NAME: ELI HAZAN VS. VOLKSWAGEN GROUP OF AMERICA, INC.
***FURTHER CASE MANAGEMENT CONFERENCE**

FILED BY:

TENTATIVE RULING:

This Case Management Conference (CMC) trails the hearing on the Motion for Summary Judgment (MSJ) calendared for Line 8. If the MSJ is uncontested, then this CMC is continued to July 14, 2026 at 8:30 a.m.

2. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: MSC20-02307

CASE NAME: MCNEAL VS LIBERTY MUTUAL GROUP

HEARING ON ORDER TO SHOW CAUSE IN RE:

FILED BY:

TENTATIVE RULING:

The Court reviewed Plaintiff Linton McNeil's Declaration in Response to the Court's Order to Show cause. Defendant Kurita Jamison Pratt did not file a response. The parties are ordered to appear via Zoom or in person at 9:00 a.m. on March 18, 2026 in Department 16 for a Jury Trial Setting Conference.

3. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C24-00146

CASE NAME: IFE RAMIREZ VS. ANNA HAYTER

HEARING ON ORDER TO SHOW CAUSE IN RE: WHY ATTORNEY K.AGU SHOULD NOT BE HELD IN CONTEMPT FOR FAILURE TO APPEAR 9/22/2025 AND 1/22/2025 TO PROSECUTE THIS CASE

FILED BY:

TENTATIVE RULING:

Having reviewed the Declaration of Counsel Kenechi R. Agu in response to the Court's Order to Show Cause, the Court hereby **discharges** this OSC. No appearance is required at the March 18, 2026 hearing.

4. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C22-01727

CASE NAME: ROBERT RODRIGUEZ VS. BARRET BURKETT

HEARING ON ORDER TO SHOW CAUSE IN RE: WHY CASE SHOULD NOT BE DISMISSED FOR FAILURE TO APPEAR BY ROBERT D. RODRIGUEZ AT 1/16/2026 CMC.

FILED BY:

TENTATIVE RULING:

Having reviewed the Declaration of Robert D. Rodriguez in response to the Court's Order to Show Cause, the Court hereby **discharges** this OSC. No appearance is required in Department 16 on March 18, 2026 for this Order to Show Cause.

The Court notes that the parties are calendared for a hearing on a discovery motion before Commissioner Yamamoto at 10:30 a.m. in Department 57. Unless ordered otherwise by Commissioner Yamamoto, the parties are ordered to appear at the discovery motion at 10:30 a.m. in Department 57.

Law & Motion

5. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C22-01563

CASE NAME: CATHERINE ANGWIN GASCA VS. CITY OF BRENTWOOD

HEARING ON SUMMARY MOTION

FILED BY: CITY OF BRENTWOOD

TENTATIVE RULING:

Continued by the Court, *sua sponte*, to April 29, 2026. The Court has several documents from Plaintiff in opposing this motion, but it cannot find a copy of the opposition memorandum. It appears